



REGIONAL AI CO.

Free Starter Kit

A simple framework to know where to start, and an honest comparison of the AI tools worth your time. No overwhelm. No jargon.

Prepared by Tiffany Leahy | Founder, Regional AI Co. | regionalaico.com.au

Welcome.



Tiffany Leahy
Founder, Regional AI Co.

A NOTE FROM TIFFANY

Curiosity is the first step. And it's great to have you here.

I am Tiffany, based in regional NSW, a small business owner, and someone who knows what it is like to wear every hat. Running a business in regional Australia means you are often the CEO, the marketer, the admin team and customer service all at once. There is not always a budget for agencies. And there are rarely enough hours in the day.

I learnt first hand how AI can change that. Not in a hype driven, tech heavy way. In a practical, this actually saves me time way. I built my business around helping other regional businesses do the same. Less tech talk. More regional reality.

This kit gives you two things. A simple framework to know where to start, and an honest comparison of the tools worth your time. That is it. No overwhelm. No jargon. Just a useful starting point.

If you are running a business on your own or with a small team, this is for you. If you are a programme manager or council officer looking for something to share with your business community, this works for that too. Pass it on freely.



What is AI, actually?

When most people say AI in a business context right now, they mean large language models. Tools trained on enormous amounts of text, books, websites, articles and research, that have learned to read, write, summarise and reason. They are not databases you search. They are more like a very well read assistant you have a conversation with. You type something in plain language. It responds in plain language. You go back and forth. That is it.

What AI is good at

- **Writing and editing.** Drafts, captions, emails, proposals.
- **Thinking alongside you.** Brainstorming and structuring ideas.
- **Research and analysis.** Summarising documents, comparing options.
- **Repetitive tasks.** Anything you do every single week.

What AI is not

- **Infallible.** It gets things wrong. Always review before you use it.
- **A replacement for your judgement.** It works for you, not instead of you.
- **Private by default.** Check your settings before you trust it with anything. More on this on page 8.

DID YOU KNOW?

Think about what it would cost to have a researcher, a marketing strategist and a business advisor all on call at once. Most small businesses could never afford that. AI gives you something close to it, available at 11pm, no sick days, no retainer, no judgement. For around US\$20 a month, or nothing at all on a free plan. That is the shift.



Three ways to use AI in your business

Before we get into frameworks and tools, it helps to understand the three distinct ways AI can work in a business. Most people discover them in order, and most people start exactly where this kit starts.

MODE 1

AI as a productivity tool

This is where most people start, and where you get the fastest wins. AI helps you do the things you already do, faster and with less effort.

- Rewrite an email in half the time
- Generate a month of social captions from a short brief
- Summarise a grant document you would otherwise spend two hours reading
- Turn a voice memo into a formatted job report

An Orange electrician who runs a four person business used this mode to draft every customer follow up email in fifteen minutes a week instead of an hour. Same quality. Much less time.

MODE 2

AI as a thinking partner

Once you are comfortable with productivity tasks, the next shift is using AI to think alongside you. Not just to do tasks, but to pressure test decisions and work through problems you would otherwise pay a consultant for.

- Should I put my prices up?
- Am I ready to hire?
- Why am I not winning enough work?

These are real business questions, and AI briefed properly is genuinely useful on all of them. There is a framework for it called CRIT: Context, Role, Interview, Task. It is the difference between an average answer and a useful one.

MODE 3

AI as a builder

This is where AI moves from helping you work to changing how your business works. You use it to build something your business owns and runs.

- A marketing system that runs without an agency
- A workflow that handles a repetitive process on a schedule
- A set of AI tools trained on your business that your whole team can use

The output is not a document or an answer. It is a capability. This is what we do together in the AI Business Kickstart, specific to your business and built to your constraints.

The Task First, Tool Second framework

For most small businesses the challenge is knowing where to start. The answer is not to pick a tool and then find things to do with it. That is the wrong order. Start with the task. Go through your to do list and work out what is repeated each day, week and month.

Finding your tasks: three starting points

- 1 Use the to do list method. Brainstorm your major tasks, then highlight the sub tasks it takes to complete each one.
- 2 Review your calendar. Look at past weeks and upcoming commitments, and write down the tasks linked to them.
- 3 If you have a job description, pull out the key responsibilities linked to your role.

Once you know your tasks, apply these four steps every time, before you open a single tool.

STEP 1

Define

Write the task in one plain sentence. Not use AI to help with marketing. Something specific: write three social captions for our spring sale.

STEP 2

Assess

Is this low risk, like a draft caption, or high risk, like a legal document or a financial decision? High risk means more human oversight, not less AI.

STEP 3

Choose

The task tells you the tool. See the cheat sheet on the next page. Do not pick a tool and then find tasks for it.

STEP 4

Brief

Tell the AI who your business is, who your customer is, and what good output looks like. Context is the difference between generic and great.

The AI tools cheat sheet

Four tools worth knowing. One honest comparison. Pick the right one for your task and your setup.

Task	Claude	ChatGPT	Copilot	Gemini
Writing and editing	Careful and accurate. Holds a brand voice well.	Strong all rounder.	Good inside Word and Outlook.	Good inside Google Docs.
Creating images	Not its strength.	Good for social.	Yes, via Microsoft tools.	Strong for social.
Research and analysis	Nuanced, detailed research.	Good general research.	Searches the web in real time.	Strong with Google Search.
Working with your own files	Upload and analyse almost anything.	Good file handling.	Deep Microsoft 365 integration.	Deep Google Drive integration.
Reusable setups	Projects and Skills.	Projects and custom instructions.	Copilot plus plugins.	Gems.
Strategic thinking	Works well with the CRIT framework.	Good for brainstorming.	Better inside Microsoft apps.	Better inside Google Workspace.
Cost	Free. Pro about US\$20/mo.	Free. Plus about US\$20/mo.	In some M365 plans. Pro extra.	Free. Advanced via Google One.

Anthropic, OpenAI and Google all bill in US dollars, so what lands on your card moves with the exchange rate and GST goes on top. Around A\$30 a month at mid 2026 rates.

WHERE TO START

On Microsoft 365? Start with Copilot, it is already in the tools you use.

Mostly writing, documents and thinking work? Start with Claude.

On Google Workspace? Start with Gemini. Same reason.

Want one tool that does a bit of everything? Start with ChatGPT.

ALSO WORTH KNOWING

Google NotebookLM is free and works differently from everything else on this list. You upload your own documents and it only ever answers from within what you have given it. It does not pull from the general internet. Useful for a tender brief, grant guidelines, an industry report, or all your policies in one place for the team to ask questions of.



How to train your AI model

Have you ever asked an AI tool to write something for your business and the output was so wrong it was almost funny? Too formal, too generic, could have belonged to any business in any town anywhere. That is not the tool failing. That is the most important step being skipped. You have to brief AI like it is your new team member.

If you hired someone and on day one handed them a task with no context, no idea what your business does or how you speak, you would get average output at best. That is exactly what happens when you open a fresh chat and jump straight to the task.

In Claude

Create a Project for your business and add your instructions and files. Every chat inside it starts with your context loaded. Skills go a step further and teach it how you do a specific job.

In ChatGPT

Create a Project for the same reason. Use Custom Instructions under Settings for the rules you want applied to every new chat, everywhere.

AT MINIMUM

- **What your business does.** One or two plain sentences, how you would explain it at a BBQ.
- **Where you are based.** Regional context matters more than you think.
- **Who your customers are.** What they care about and what problems you solve.
- **How you sound.** Warm and casual, direct and professional, friendly but no nonsense.
- **What you never say.** Any words, claims or topics the tool should avoid.

The proper way: a Brand Bible

A Brand Bible captures everything an AI tool needs to represent your business accurately. Your values, your edge, your customers and your guardrails. Load it into any AI tool and the output shifts from generic to genuinely useful. You stop editing for tone and start editing for content.

WE BUILD THESE WITH CLIENTS

We build Brand Bibles with clients in the AI Business Kickstart, working through strategy, voice, values and customers in a single session. See the last page.

Data, security, and keeping your business safe

This is the section most people skip. It is also the one that matters most when you are running a real business with real clients and real responsibilities.

It is not free versus paid. It is a setting.

This is the most misunderstood thing about AI right now, so it is worth being precise. On consumer plans, free and paid alike, most AI tools can use your conversations to help improve their models. Paying for a subscription does not switch that off on its own.

What actually keeps your data out is either turning the setting off yourself, or being on a business tier such as Claude Team or Enterprise, where it is off by default. Two minutes in your settings does more for your data safety than the subscription does.

Do this first, on every account you use

In Claude: Settings, then Privacy, then turn off help improve our AI models. In ChatGPT: Settings, then Data controls. Ten seconds each, and most people have never done it.

What is safe to put in

Safe to use	Use with caution	Never put in AI tools
General business questions and research	Client names and details, with permission	Bank account or payment details
Your own business description and voice	Staff personal information	Signed contracts or legal agreements
Marketing content and copy drafts	Specific financial figures	Customer personal data without consent
Industry research and competitor analysis	Unpublished pricing or tender responses	Passwords or login credentials

The businesses that will fall behind are not the ones who are careful. They are the ones who avoid AI entirely because the uncertainty felt too big to get past. Use it carefully. Not fearfully.

The AI Business Kickstart

You have got a feel for what AI can do and you know the tools worth your time. The next question most business owners hit is: now what?

How do I get AI to actually sound like my business, not a generic version of it? How do I use it to think through a real decision, not just write a caption? How do I set it up so my whole team uses it consistently, without me explaining everything from scratch every time?

Knowing what the tools can do and having a setup that runs properly inside your business are two different things. The Kickstart is where we build the second one, together, in one working session.

WHAT YOU LEAVE WITH

- **Your Brand Bible, built with you**

We work through your strategy, voice, values, customers and what sets you apart, in the session. Not a template you fill in later.

- **Your guardrails, written down**

What goes in, what never does, in plain language you can hand straight to your team.

- **Your context, loaded**

From that point on, every AI tool you use starts already knowing who your business is and how to represent it.

- **Built to your constraints**

Your business, your customers, your time and your budget. Not big city theory.

\$750

One session · Real output

One working session where we set up your AI system properly for your business. You leave with something that works.

Book a Kickstart

Not ready for a session? Reply to the email this kit came from and tell me where you are stuck. I answer them all.